10-20 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Our School Canteen Keep the "Silent Dining" Rule?

① In many middle schools in our city, including ours, the canteen follows a rule called **"Silent Dining"**: while students are eating, **no talking is allowed**. Meals are finished in about 20 minutes, then everyone leaves in lines. Some people praise this rule as "clean and efficient". Others call it "cold" and "unnatural". After thinking carefully, I believe the rule should be **kept, but softened**.

② Supporters of "Silent Dining" give three good reasons. First, **safety**. If a student laughs with a mouthful of rice, the food can block his throat. Every year in China, a few children die of food choking; a **silent table** clearly lowers this risk. Second, **efficiency**. A canteen that serves 1,600 students in one hour cannot waste minutes on shouting. Silence keeps the queue moving, and students return to class with time to rest. Third, **manners**. Looking at your food, not talking with food in your mouth, and waiting for others are **quiet signs of respect** — the same signs our grandparents expected of us at the family table.

③ However, those who dislike the rule are not only complaining about fun. They raise real worries. One, **a meal is not only food**. For adults, dinner with friends is one of the warmest parts of life: a space for small jokes, small confessions, small questions. If students spend **twenty minutes a day** eating in total silence for three years, they may grow into young adults who feel **awkward at any dining table**. Two, "silence" can hide **loneliness**. In a noisy canteen, a student who is being bullied may whisper a cry for help; in a silent one, he may eat alone for months with no one noticing. Three, the rule is hard to follow **fairly**. Teachers on duty often shout "Quiet!" only at the weakest-looking students, while louder groups keep laughing in the corner.

④ These worries do not kill the rule; they only show that **"silent" is too simple a word**. A better version might be called "**Low-Voice Dining**". Two small changes would make a big difference. First, allow students to **speak softly** at the table, only with the classmates next to them, in voices no louder than the air-conditioning hum. Shouts across the room are still forbidden. Second, keep **two silent minutes** at the start of each meal for careful chewing, then open the rest of the time for quiet talk. In this way, both safety and warmth can share the same table.

⑤ Some people still ask, "What if a minority of students go wild?" The answer is not to bring back total silence, but to let the **class itself** take responsibility. Each week, one group of six students can be the "table monitors", remind others in a friendly voice, and

report — not shout. A rule that trains students to manage themselves is far more useful than one that trains them to stay silent in front of a teacher and be wild behind her back.

⑥ A canteen is a strange classroom. It teaches without a textbook. If the lesson is only "sit still, chew in silence, hurry back", we may be training young people who eat fast and feel slowly. But if we can turn twenty minutes a day into a calm, kind space — where food is safe, noise is low, and words are gentle — then the canteen will teach what no history class can: **how to share a table, and how to share a life.**

注释： canteen 食堂；choking 呛到；awkward 尴尬的；minority 少数；responsibility 责任

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Which of the following is a reason given for the "Silent Dining" rule?

A. Students do not like to talk.
B. Safety (food choking), efficiency in a big canteen, and polite manners.
C. Teachers are tired of noise in class.
D. Silence saves the school electricity.

2. According to Paragraph ③, what is the first worry about total silence at meals?

A. Students will eat too much.
B. A meal is not only food; students who eat in silence for years may later feel awkward at any dining table and miss the warmth of shared meals.
C. Students will get cold.
D. The food will be wasted.

3. What problem of "unfair enforcement" does the writer mention?

A. Teachers on duty often shout "Quiet!" only at the weakest-looking students, while louder groups keep laughing in the corner.
B. Rich students eat in a separate hall.
C. Some students get larger plates.
D. Teachers eat free meals.

4. What does the writer suggest as a better rule?

A. No rule at all.
B. Total silence for the whole meal.
C. "Low-Voice Dining": soft voices with neighbours; no shouting across the room; two silent minutes at the start for careful chewing, then quiet talk.
D. Students eat alone in their classrooms.

5. What is the writer's final idea in the last paragraph?

A. Canteens should be as noisy as markets.
B. A canteen should train students to eat fast and say nothing.
C. A canteen is a classroom that should teach students how to share a table, and how to share a life — through food that is safe, voices that are low, and words that are gentle.
D. Canteens should be replaced by vending machines.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段三项理由 safety / efficiency / manners
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "a meal is not only food ... awkward at any dining table"
【解析】担忧核心。A、C、D 无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段第三条 "shout 'Quiet!' only at the weakest-looking students"
【解析】执行不公。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "Low-Voice Dining ... speak softly ... two silent minutes"
【解析】两项修改共同构成新规则。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题 / 作者观点题
【定位】第⑥段结尾 "how to share a table, and how to share a life"
【解析】作者立场清晰、收尾寄望。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。